

HOMEWORK 1 SOLUTIONS

SECTION 1.1

① a

We substitute $x = 19t - 35$, $y = 25 - 13t$, $z = t$ on each of the equations of the system:

$$\bullet 2(19t - 35) + 3(25 - 13t) + t = 38t - 70 + 75 - 39t + t = 5 + 0t = 5 \quad \checkmark$$

$$\bullet 5(19t - 35) + 7(25 - 13t) - 4t = 95t - 175 + 175 - 91t - 4t = 0 \quad \checkmark$$

So $x = 19t - 35$, $y = 25 - 13t$, $z = t$ is indeed a solution for all values of t .

② c

Solving for y : $y = 3x + 2z - 5$ (x, z free), giving us the solution

$$x = s$$

$$y = 3s + 2t - 5, \quad s, t \text{ arbitrary}$$

$$z = t$$

We could solve for z instead, to obtain

$$x = p$$

$$y = q, \quad p, q \text{ arbitrary}$$

$$z = \frac{5}{2} - \frac{3}{2}p + \frac{1}{2}q$$

⑦

a $\left[\begin{array}{cc|c} 1 & -3 & 5 \\ 2 & 1 & 1 \end{array} \right]$

b $\left[\begin{array}{cc|c} 1 & 2 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \end{array} \right]$

c $\left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & -1 & 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 0 & -1 & 1 \\ 2 & 1 & 0 & 0 \end{array} \right]$

d $\left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ -1 & 0 & 1 & 2 \end{array} \right]$

⑧

a $\begin{cases} x - y + 6z = 0 \\ y = 3 \\ 2x - y = 1 \end{cases}$

b $\begin{cases} 2x - y = -1 \\ -3x + 2y + z = 0 \\ y + z = 3 \end{cases}$

9 d

$$\begin{bmatrix} 3 & 4 & | & 1 \\ 4 & 5 & | & -3 \end{bmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_1 \leftrightarrow R_2} \begin{bmatrix} 4 & 5 & | & -3 \\ 3 & 4 & | & 1 \end{bmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_1 - R_2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & | & -4 \\ 3 & 4 & | & 1 \end{bmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_2 - 3R_1} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & | & -4 \\ 0 & 1 & | & 13 \end{bmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_1 - R_2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & | & -17 \\ 0 & 1 & | & 13 \end{bmatrix}$$

Arguing as with the previous system, we conclude that this system has a unique solution:

$$x = -17, y = 13$$

14 a

FALSE : The system $\{x+y=2\}$ has $n=2$ variables and $m=1$ equation, but the augmented matrix $[1 \ 1 \ 2]$ only has one row.

b

FALSE: The system from problem 10a is consistent but does not have infinitely many solutions.

C

TRUE: Row operations preserve solutions, so if we apply a row operation to a consistent system, the result is also consistent.

d

TRUE: Because row operations are reversible and preserve the solution of a system, then the original system has to be inconsistent if it is carried to an inconsistent system via row operations.

SECTION 1.2.

② $\square a$

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \left[\begin{array}{cccccc} 0 & -1 & 2 & 1 & 2 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 & -2 & 2 & 7 & 4 \\ 0 & -2 & 4 & 3 & 7 & 1 \\ 0 & 3 & -6 & 1 & 6 & 1 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{-R_1} \left[\begin{array}{cccccc} 0 & 1 & -2 & -1 & -2 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 & -2 & 2 & 7 & 2 \\ 0 & -2 & 4 & 3 & 7 & 1 \\ 0 & 3 & -6 & 1 & 6 & 1 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{\substack{R_2 - R_1 \\ R_3 + 2R_1 \\ R_4 - 3R_1}} \left[\begin{array}{cccccc} 0 & 1 & -2 & -1 & -2 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 3 & 9 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 4 & 12 & 7 \end{array} \right] \\
 & \xrightarrow{R_2 \leftrightarrow R_3} \left[\begin{array}{cccccc} 0 & 1 & -2 & -1 & -2 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 3 & 9 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 4 & 12 & 7 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{\substack{R_3 - 3R_2 \\ R_4 - 4R_2}} \left[\begin{array}{cccccc} 0 & 1 & -2 & -1 & -2 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 6 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 11 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{R_4 - 2R_3} \left[\begin{array}{cccccc} 0 & 1 & -2 & -1 & -2 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 6 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & -1 \end{array} \right] \\
 & \xrightarrow{R_3 \leftrightarrow R_4} \left[\begin{array}{cccccc} 0 & 1 & -2 & -1 & -2 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 6 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{-R_3} \left[\begin{array}{cccccc} 0 & 1 & -2 & -1 & -2 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 6 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{R_4 - 6R_3} \left[\begin{array}{cccccc} 0 & 1 & -2 & -1 & -2 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & -27 \end{array} \right] \\
 & \xrightarrow{-\frac{1}{27}R_4} \left[\begin{array}{cccccc} 0 & 1 & -2 & -1 & -2 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{\substack{R_3 - 4R_4 \\ R_2 - 2R_4 \\ R_1 - R_4}} \left[\begin{array}{cccccc} 0 & 1 & -2 & -1 & -2 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{\substack{R_1 + R_3 \\ R_2 + R_3}} \left[\begin{array}{cccccc} 0 & 1 & -2 & -1 & -2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right]
 \end{aligned}$$

$$\xrightarrow{R_1+R_2} \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 & -2 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

The rank of this matrix is 4.

③ b

$$\begin{cases} x_1 - 2x_2 + 2x_4 + x_6 = 1 \\ x_3 + 5x_4 - 3x_6 = -1 \\ x_5 + 6x_6 = 1 \end{cases}$$

$\uparrow$ $\uparrow$ $\uparrow$ $\uparrow$ $\uparrow$
 $x_2 = r$ $x_4 = s$ $x_6 = t$
 Leading variables

$$\begin{aligned} x_1 &= 1 + 2r - 2s + t, & x_2 &= r & x_3 &= -1 - 5s + 3t \\ x_4 &= s, & x_5 &= 1 - 6t & x_6 &= t \end{aligned} \quad r, s, t \text{ arbitrary}$$

c

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 1 & 3 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & -1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_1 - 3R_2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 1 & 0 & 4 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & -1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_1 - 2R_2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 3 & 0 & 2 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & -1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\begin{cases} x_1 + 3x_3 + 2x_5 = -1 \\ x_2 - x_3 + x_5 = 1 \\ x_4 - x_5 = 0 \end{cases}$$

$\uparrow$ $\uparrow$ $\uparrow$ $\uparrow$ $\uparrow$
 $x_3 = s$ $x_5 = t$
 Leading variables

$$\begin{aligned} x_1 &= -1 - 3s - 2t, & x_2 &= 1 + s - t, & x_3 &= s \\ x_4 &= t, & x_5 &= t, & s, t & \text{arbitrary} \end{aligned}$$

ALTERNATIVE WAY: Use back-substitution

$$\begin{cases} x_1 + 2x_2 + x_3 + 3x_4 + x_5 = 1 \\ x_2 - x_3 + x_5 = 1 \\ x_4 - x_5 = 0 \end{cases}$$

$\uparrow$ $\uparrow$ $\uparrow$ $\uparrow$ $\uparrow$
 $x_3 = s$ $x_5 = t$
 Leading variables

$\Rightarrow$

$$\begin{aligned} x_5 &= t, & x_4 &= x_5 = t, & x_3 &= s, & x_2 &= 1 + x_3 - x_5 = 1 + s - t, \\ x_1 &= 1 - 2x_2 - x_3 - 3x_4 - x_5 = 1 - 2(1 + s - t) - s - 3t - t = -1 - 3s - 2t \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} x_1 &= -1 - 3s - 2t, & x_2 &= 1 + s - t, & x_3 &= s \\ x_4 &= t, & x_5 &= t, & s, t & \text{arbitrary} \end{aligned}$$

5 d

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & -1 & | & 2 \\ 2 & 5 & -3 & | & 1 \\ 1 & 4 & -3 & | & 3 \end{bmatrix} \xrightarrow[\substack{R_2 - 2R_1 \\ R_3 - R_1}]{\substack{R_2 - 2R_1 \\ R_3 - R_1}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & -1 & | & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & | & -3 \\ 0 & 2 & -2 & | & 1 \end{bmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_3 - 2R_2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & -1 & | & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & | & -3 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & | & 7 \end{bmatrix}$$

Inconsistent, because it contains the equation $0=7$.

h

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & -4 & | & 10 \\ 2 & -1 & 2 & | & 5 \\ 1 & 1 & -2 & | & 7 \end{bmatrix} \xrightarrow[\substack{R_3 - R_1 \\ R_2 - 2R_1}]{\substack{R_3 - R_1 \\ R_2 - 2R_1}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & -4 & | & 10 \\ 0 & -5 & 10 & | & -15 \\ 0 & -1 & 2 & | & -3 \end{bmatrix} \xrightarrow{-\frac{1}{5}R_2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & -4 & | & 10 \\ 0 & 1 & -2 & | & 3 \\ 0 & -1 & 2 & | & -3 \end{bmatrix} \xrightarrow[\substack{R_1 - 2R_2 \\ R_3 + R_2}]{\substack{R_1 - 2R_2 \\ R_3 + R_2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & | & 4 \\ 0 & 1 & -2 & | & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & | & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\begin{cases} x = 4 \\ y - 2z = 3 \end{cases}$$

↑ ↑ ↑
Leading z = t

$$\begin{aligned} x &= 4 \\ y &= 3 + 2t \quad t \text{ arbitrary} \\ z &= t \end{aligned}$$

9 c

$$\begin{bmatrix} -1 & 3 & 2 & | & -8 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 & | & 2 \\ 3 & 3 & a & | & b \end{bmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_1 \leftrightarrow R_2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & | & 2 \\ -1 & 3 & 2 & | & -8 \\ 3 & 3 & a & | & b \end{bmatrix} \xrightarrow[\substack{R_3 - 3R_1 \\ R_2 + R_1}]{\substack{R_3 - 3R_1 \\ R_2 + R_1}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & | & 2 \\ 0 & 3 & 3 & | & -6 \\ 0 & 3 & a-3 & | & b-6 \end{bmatrix} \xrightarrow{\frac{1}{3}R_2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & | & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & | & -2 \\ 0 & 3 & a-3 & | & b-6 \end{bmatrix} \xrightarrow{R_3 - 3R_2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & | & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & | & -2 \\ 0 & 0 & a-6 & | & b \end{bmatrix}$$

The system is inconsistent if and only if the last row is $[0 \ 0 \ 0 \ | \ b]$ and $b \neq 0$. This happens only if $a-6=0$ (i.e. $a=6$) and $b \neq 0$. Thus, the system is consistent if and only if $a \neq 6$ or $b=0$.

CASE I: $a \neq 6$.

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & | & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & | & -2 \\ 0 & 0 & a-6 & | & b \end{bmatrix} \xrightarrow{\frac{1}{a-6}R_3} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & | & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & | & -2 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & | & \frac{b}{a-6} \end{bmatrix}$$

• Rank of augmented matrix = 3 = n° of variables
 $\Rightarrow$ The system has a unique solution

CASE II: $a=6$ (so $b=0$ in order for the system to be consistent)

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & | & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & | & -2 \\ 0 & 0 & a-6 & | & b \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & | & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & | & -2 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & | & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

• Rank of augmented matrix = 2 < 3 = n° of variables
 $\Rightarrow$ Infinitely many solutions:

CONCLUSION:

- No solutions precisely when $a=6$ and $b=0$
- Unique solution precisely when $a \neq 6$
- Infinitely many solutions precisely when $a=6$ and $b \neq 0$